

as to prevent hard disk overheating. You can also pause the process if you want to do something on your computer that makes use of files on the disk being defragmented. Also note that you can stop the defrag process at any time—again, you might want to do this if it's taking too long. It's not exactly the same, but when you choose to defrag the disk later, it pretty much picks up where it left off.

After having analysed a drive, you can choose to view the report by, of course, clicking on 'View Report'. This gives you the details of what files on the drive are defragmented and to what degree. Of course, files defragmented into too many pieces are bad news. One trick you can apply here (if you have more than one partition and/or physical drive) is to move the heavily-fragmented file to another partition, defragment the current partition, and then bring the file back to the original drive. In most cases, when the file is copied back, it gets copied as a contiguous piece.

9.1.2 Using The Command Prompt

For those who like to use the command prompt, here is a list of the switches you can use with the 'defrag' command.

The syntax is "defrag volume [/a] [/v] [/f] [/?]

volume

The drive letter or a mount point of the volume to be defragmented.

/a

Analyses the volume, displays a summary of the analysis report, and indicates whether you should defragment the volume.

/v

Displays the complete analysis and defragmentation reports. When used in combination with /a, displays only the analysis report. When used alone, displays both the analysis and defragmentation reports.